

Exploring Military Vehicles

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![[Cover]](h7fig:cover)

****Global military vehicles**** — land, sea, air, subsurface, and space; every major class and representative system.

For operators, Hostess 7 IFF counsel, and AI exhaustive retrieval.

- ****Updated:**** 2026-06-30T20:45:28Z
- ****Scope:**** worldwide — NATO, CSTO, neutral, and global south systems
- ****Law:**** Geneva Conventions marking for medical/civilian-protected vehicles

1. History — military vehicles by era

Era	Land	Sea	Air
Ancient	Chariot, elephant	Trireme, quinquereme	—
Gunpowder	Cannon carriage	Ship of the line	Balloon recon (1790s)
WWI	Mark I tank	U-boat	Sopwith Camel, Zeppelin
WWII	Tiger, T-34	Bismarck, Essex CV	Spitfire, B-17, Zero
Cold War	T-72, M60	Typhoon SSBN	F-4, MiG-21, U-2
Modern	T-14, KF-51	Type 055 destroyer	F-35, Su-57, TB2

2. Definition

A ****military vehicle**** is designed or substantially used for ****military transport or combat****.

Most require ****off-road mobility****, ****armor****, or ****tracks****. Amphibious variants cross land/water.

Non-combat medical vehicles must be ****clearly marked**** and are protected under Geneva when respected.

3. Land combat vehicles

- Tank: MBT (Leopard 2, M1 Abrams, T-90, Type 99, Merkava, K2)
- Light tank / tankette (historical: FT-17, Panzer I; modern: 2S25 Sprut-class)
- IFV: Bradley, BMP-3, CV90, Puma, ZBD-04, Warrior
- APC: M113, BTR-80, Patria AMV, Boxer (APC role), Type 92
- MRAP: Cougar, MaxxPro, RG-33, Typhoon-K (regional variants)
- Recon: Fennek, BRDM-2, LAV-25, Scimitar (CVR(T))
- Self-propelled artillery: PzH 2000, M109, 2S19 Msta, PLZ-05
- MLRS: M270 HIMARS, BM-30 Smerch, PHL-03

- SPAAG: Gepard, Tunguska, Pantsir-S1 (land-based)
- Tank destroyer / wheeled AT: Centauro, M1128 Stryker MGS, Pandur
- Half-track (historical): Sd.Kfz series, M3 half-track
- Improvised: technical (pickup MG), gun truck, up-armored civilian

3a. AFV comparison axes (AI index)

Axis	Question	Example values
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Role	Tank vs IFV vs APC	MBT / IFV / APC / MRAP
Mobility	Tracks vs wheels	Tracked MBT / 8x8 Boxer
Armor	Steel vs composite vs ERA	RHA, NERA, Kontakt-5
Main armament	Cannon / missile	120 mm smoothbore, ATGM
Crew	Headcount	3–4 tank, 7–9 IFV
Origin	Country block	USA, Germany, Russia, China, ...

4. Logistics & support trucks

- Heavy truck: HEMTT, KamAZ, MAZ, Oshkosh FMTV, Tatra
- Medium: Unimog military, MAN HX, Iveco MTV
- Fuel tanker, water bowser, ammunition truck
- Tractor-trailer: heavy equipment transport (HET)
- Ambulance (Geneva marked), field hospital trucks
- Engineer: bridge layer (M60 AVLB, PMM-2), mine plow, dozer in uniform

5. Naval military vessels

- Aircraft carrier: CATOBAR, STOBAR, STOVL (Nimitz, Ford, Kuznetsov-class)
- Destroyer / frigate / corvette (AEGIS, Type 052D, FREMM)
- Cruiser (Ticonderoga-class legacy), littoral combat ship
- Submarine: SSN, SSBN, SSK (Virginia, Astute, Yasen, Type 093)
- Amphibious: LHD/LHA (Wasp, America), LST, LCAC hovercraft
- Patrol: FAC, OPV, riverine craft
- Mine warfare: MCM vessel, minesweeper
- Auxiliary: replenishment oiler (T-AO), hospital ship (USNS Mercy-class)

6. Subsurface & undersea

- SSN: Virginia-class, Astute, Yasen-M, Suffren, Type 093
- SSBN: Ohio, Vanguard, Borei, Triumphant, Type 094
- SSK: Type 212A AIP, Kilo, Scorpène, Soryu

- UUV: REMUS, Bluefin, Poseidon (status-classified) — autonomous undersea
- SDV: SEAL Delivery Vehicle — swimmer lock-out

7. Military aircraft & unmanned systems

- Fighter: F-35, F-22, Su-35, J-20, Rafale, Typhoon, Gripen
- Strike/attack: A-10, Su-25, JH-7
- Bomber: B-52, B-2, B-21, Tu-160, H-6
- Transport: C-130, C-17, A400M, Il-76, Y-20
- Tanker: KC-135, KC-46, Il-78
- AWACS/AEW: E-3, E-7 Wedgetail, A-50, KJ-500
- Maritime patrol: P-8 Poseidon, P-3 Orion
- Helicopter: UH-60, CH-47, Mi-8/17, Ka-52, AH-64
- UAV/UCAV: MQ-9 Reaper, Bayraktar TB2, Shahed-136 (loitering munition)

8. Historical eras (narrative)

- Ancient–medieval: chariot, war elephant, siege tower, trireme
- WWI: Mark I tank, Renault FT, early aircraft, U-boat
- WWII: Tiger, T-34, Sherman, Jeep, Stuka, Spitfire, Iowa-class
- Cold War: T-72, M60, BTR, MiG-21, F-4, SSBN boomers
- Modern: networked IFV, stealth fighter, drone swarms, APS (active protection)

9. Global regions (representative fleets)

Region	Land example	Naval example	Air example
United States	M1 Abrams	Nimitz/Ford CVN	F-35A/C
United Kingdom	Challenger 2	Queen Elizabeth CV	Typhoon
France	Leclerc	Charles de Gaulle	Rafale
Germany	Leopard 2	Baden-Württemberg F125	Eurofighter
Russia	T-90M	Admiral Kuznetsov	Su-35S
China	Type 99A	Type 003 Fujian	J-20
India	Arjun	INS Vikrant	Tejas
Japan	Type 10	Izumo-class	F-35A
South Korea	K2 Black Panther	Dokdo LPH	KF-21
Israel	Merkava IV	Sa'ar corvette	F-35I
Turkey	Altay	Anadolu LHD	Bayraktar TB2
Ukraine	T-64BM	Gyurza gunboat	Su-27 legacy
Brazil	Guarani	Tamandaré frigate	Gripen E
Australia	Boxer CRV	Hobart destroyer	F/A-18F

10. Non-combat protected vehicles

- Military ambulance (Red Cross/Crescent emblem)
- Mobile surgical hospital (field hospital)
- Chaplain/civilian aid convoys (protected when marked)
- POW transport (Geneva obligations)

11. Improvised & irregular warfare

- Technical: civilian pickup with crew-served weapon
- Up-armored civilian (Ukraine-style, Iraq-style)
- Suicide vehicle-borne IED (SVBIED) — threat class, not doctrine
- Captured/refurbished enemy kit (trophy AFVs)

12. Space & strategic (military)

- ICBM silo & TEL: Minuteman III, RS-24 Yars, DF-41, Agni-V
- SLBM: Trident II, Bulava, JL-2
- Military satellite buses: WGS, SBIRS, Yaogan, Gaofen mil-dual
- ASAT: USA-193 intercept (2008), Cosmos 1408 (2021) — policy-sensitive
- X-37B OTV: reusable military spaceplane
- Starship / super-heavy (dual-use launch — track as policy)

13. AI retrieval keys

Index by `domain` (land/sea/air/space), `role`, `country`, `era`, `protected\_status`. Dewey ****355**** military science. Pair civilian base vehicles with **Exploring Vehicles**.

Appendix — NATO designator patterns (selected)

Pattern	Meaning
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M1xx	US tracked AFV family
BTR-xx	Soviet/Russian wheeled APC lineage
FV4xx	British AFV lineage
Type 0xx	Chinese PLA designations
CV9x	Nordic IFV exports

Corroborate lethal and identification claims through field evidence and Hostess 7 truth gates. Educational exhaustive catalog — not targeting doctrine.